

Reflection Paper Nee Text

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General Overview

The book by Nee was very succinct in that it is summarized by three points: sit, walk, and stand. I believe this was a very wise choice of words that is very biblical. It is found in the Ephesians text of the Bible, and it is in chronological order of the text. The author is stating that we must sit in Christ and rest in him, which leads to action of living out the Christian life, and then we stand and withstand and defeat the devil. The focus is the active Christian life and ultimate fight we must fight. The key reason he authored this text was that we must know what the Christian life is in order to understand what we must do to live it out. It counsels us and encourages us to fight the battle, and reinforces what we already know.

Key Points

1) **Sit**. I thought it was a very wise thing to say that we must sit in Christ. The Bible text he selected for this was subtle - it says we are sitteth with Christ in the heavenlies. It is not a strong verse or passage, but he emphasized something small and made it significant. Sit means to rest in Christ and know that he is God and the he does all things and we must be submissive and responsive to him. It is to know the battle has already been won. It touched my heart because we always need to rest and sit, and sometimes we just get too busy. I think it is poignant for today's society that we find Christ first so that we can rest in him. Too many people are looking in the wrong place for the wrong thing. We need Christ, and to rest in him.

2) **Walk**. I found this to be insightful as well. There are several beautiful verses in Ephesians that include the word "walk," and I think it was a good choice of a word to exposit.

Walk means to live out the Christian life, to put off bad things and to put on good things. Walk means to live in accordance with God in righteousness. It is to obey his laws and to please God. It is to patiently endure all things and never give in to evil and never give up. It is to be crucified to the world and to sin.

Walk stands out to me because it means a constant action of going forward. We cannot rest in some sense, we have to keep going. We cannot play games and be side-tracked - the Bible says that we are soldiers who don't get involved in civilian affairs.

It touches my heart because this is the hardest part of the Christian life - to suffer and carry our cross. This is what it means to walk properly.

3) **Stand**. I believe "stand" means that we must get hit by the devil with many blows and still stand strong. The devil will try to get us to slip and to fall and to do evil. He will trick us in so many various ways, and we must counteract everything and stand after all attacks. It stands out to me because it tells us that we have an enemy - the devil - who is trying to destroy us.

It touched my heart because we will overcome all evil and tribulation. We are overcomers, and we will win and have already won.

Personal Application

What I learned most for my personal walk with the Lord was that I must first rest in the Lord. This is very counter-intuitive because you would think you need to run to your destination before you can rest there. But the Christian life is to "let go and let God." We have to give up all of our selfishness and desire and strength, and simply let God do everything for us. Being able to rest is not easy as it is much easier to rely on our own strength and wisdom. To rest in God

means that you have been sanctified and that all that evil and dross has been pushed out of your system.

By resting in Christ we are fully trusting in God and all the foundation for the Christian life has been created. We are then ready to fight the good fight and win the race. We are then ready to “walk.”

To walk is to live the Christian life - to exert energy, to fight the fight, and to run the race. It is putting off the old self and putting on the new. It is waiting patiently when evil is tempting you and giving you trial, and giving good and blessing to others when they revile you. It is the doing of the Christian life and it is working out your salvation. It is God’s work as we are resting, but it is also our work because we are doing it.

We need to understand that God is actively walking with us and is watching how we step. Every step of faith into the light is another reward in heaven that will grant us great blessing in the afterlife. The fruit of the Spirit is the great blessing that we impart to the world.

Walking is something that I learned is so hard in my walk with the Lord. It is painful at times, and it is strenuous. It is not romantic and it is brutal. Lifting myself up when I am very tired is very difficult. Truly, to walk in Christ is to be crucified with Him, and to be a minister of Christ, I must be prepared to walk this path.

I was touched by the fact that standing against Satan is the great task that we must have once we are ready to fight the good fight. We have an enemy. And that we can overcome all the evil schemes of the devil is great comfort to me - it is a predestination of victory since we rest in victory.

I need to improve in crucifying myself and allowing myself to be crucified. No one can do this well, it is forced upon us and we must bear the burden.

The standing and walking in Christ addressed this need.

Bibliography

Nee, Watchman. *Sit, Walk, Stand*. Fort Washington, PA: Christian Literature Crusade, 1962.